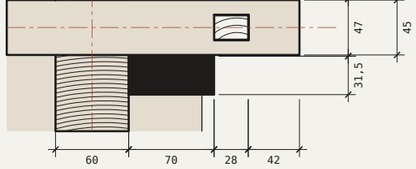
punto fermo.

a trestle table in solid walnut, with one stone in the joint

Wood moves and comes apart; the only fixed point is the stone where it locks.

Solid wood moves about 14 mm per metre between seasons; stone does not move. Six loose walnut boards are each pinned on their axis and locked by an ash wedge: the joint between them shows the season.

The only fixed point is a collar of **Nero Sahara Noir**. The stretcher's through-tenon passes through the post and through the stone; an ash key, set with a mallet, presses the stone against the post. The stone works only in compression, never glued, never in bending.



the joint, horizontal section 1:5: post (end grain), tenon, stone collar (black), ash key. 1 mm clearance per side; the stone is only squeezed



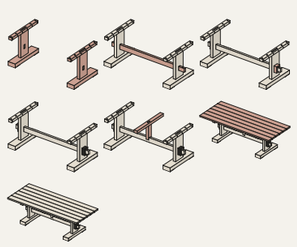
noce canaletta, frassino, nero sahara noir · 2400 × 1000 × 750 mm · 8 people

1 at the table



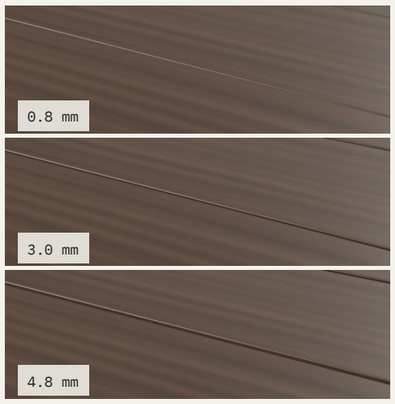
eight people; the ends stay free for the knees: the trestles stand 450 mm from the ends

2 assembly



seven steps, one mallet, no hardware; no part weighs more than 16 kg

3 seasons



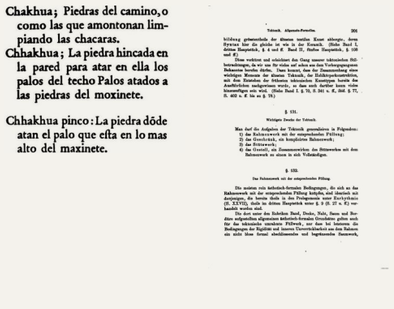
the joint between boards: 0.8 mm humid, 3 mm as made, 4.8 mm dry. the stone does not move

4 repair



two wedges out, the spline slides out through the end, one board lifts away

→ sources



Bertonio 1612: chhakhua, the stone where the poles are tied

Semper 1879: the table as Gestell

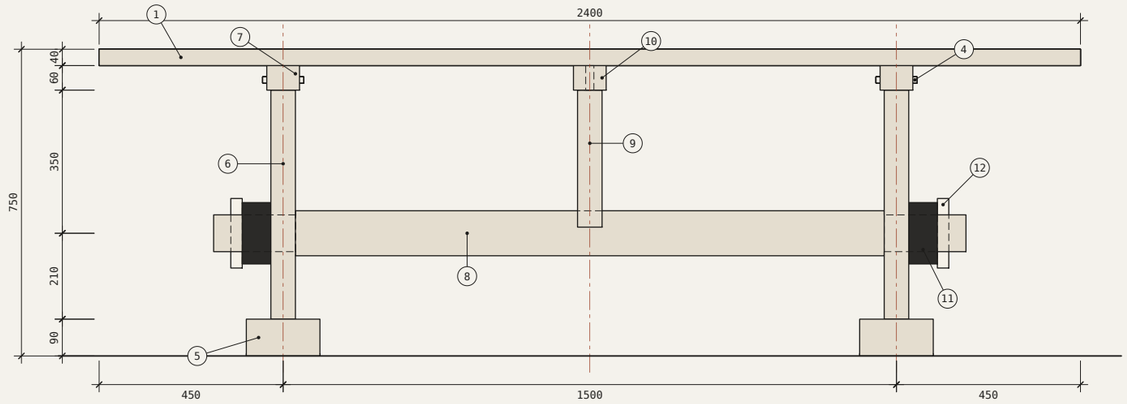


Viollet-le-Duc 1873: tables on trestles, «pas à demeure»

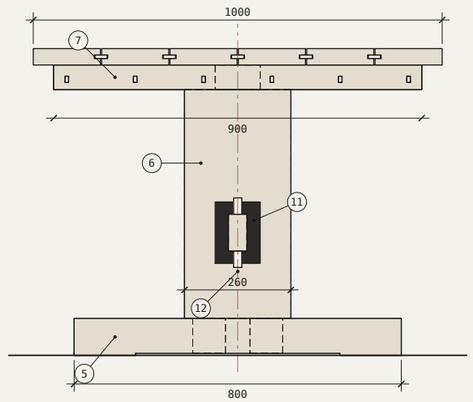


Squier 1877: Tiwanaku stones cut «like mortise and tenon»

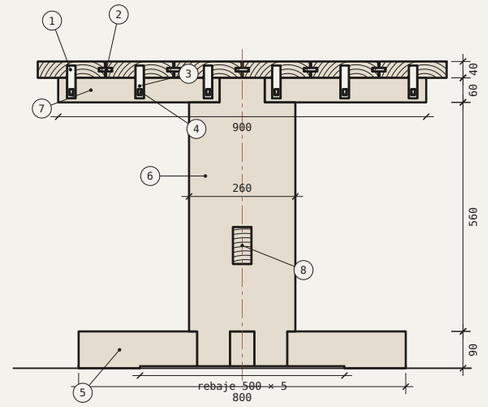
elevation 1:15



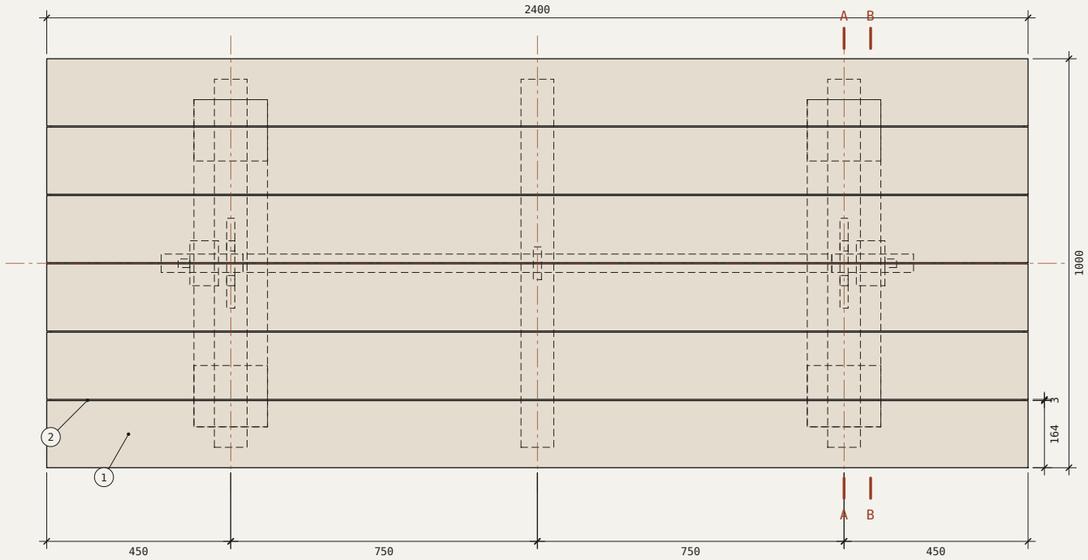
end elevation 1:15



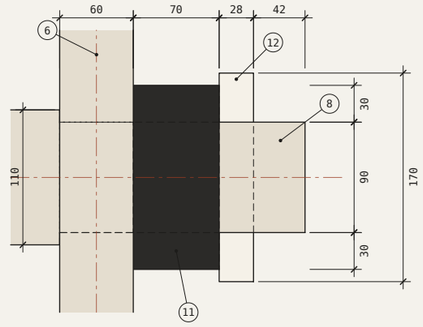
section a-a, through the trestle 1:15



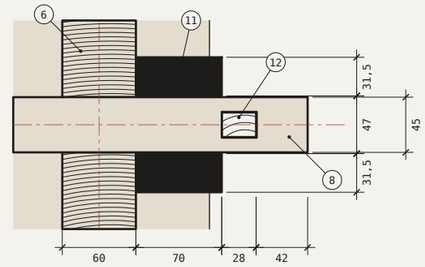
plan 1:15



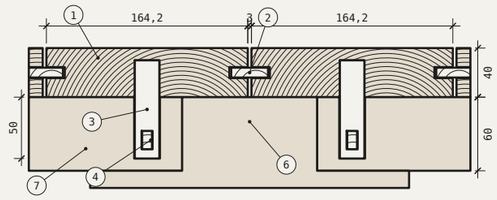
the joint, elevation 1:5



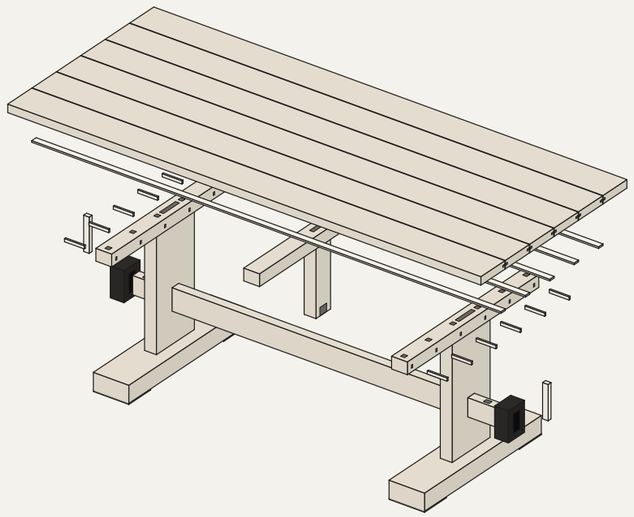
the joint, horizontal section 1:5



boards on the head: dowel, wedge, spline 1:5



exploded axonometry 1:25

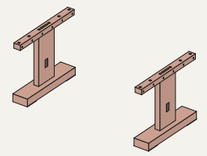


parts

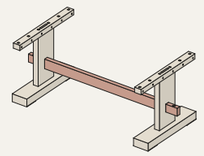
no.	part	material	mm	qty	kg
1	board	noce canaletta	2400 × 164.2 × 40	6	58.2
2	spline	frassino	2380 × 30 × 8	5	1.9
3	dowel	frassino	80 × 20 × 20	12	0.3
4	wedge	frassino	100 × 15 × 8	12	0.1
5	foot	noce canaletta	800 × 180 × 90	2	16.0
6	post	noce canaletta	560 × 260 × 60	2	10.8
7	head	noce canaletta	900 × 80 × 60	2	5.3
10	central head	noce canaletta	900 × 80 × 60	1	2.7
8	stretcher	noce canaletta	1840 × 110 × 45	1	5.6
9	central strut	noce canaletta	295 × 100 × 60	1	1.1
11	collar	Nero Sahara Noir	150 × 110 × 70	2	4.6
12	key	frassino	170 × 28 × 20	2	0.1
	total			**48**	**106.7**

tolerances: 1 mm per side in the stone, 0.5 mm in loose joints · the trestle is glued (through-tenons, wedged); everything else comes apart · walnut and ash oiled · stone honed, 3 mm chamfers · ash key tapered 1:40 · numbers in circles: parts list

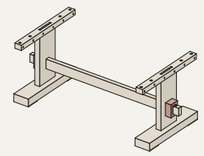
assembly, in seven steps



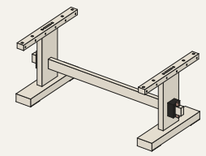
1 stand the trestles



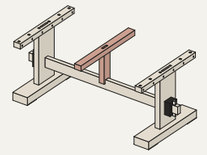
2 the stretcher through the posts



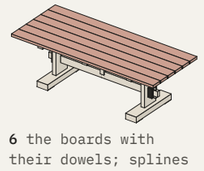
3 the stone collars onto the tenons



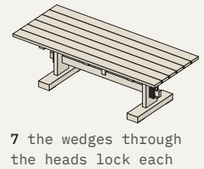
4 the keys press the stone: one mallet blow



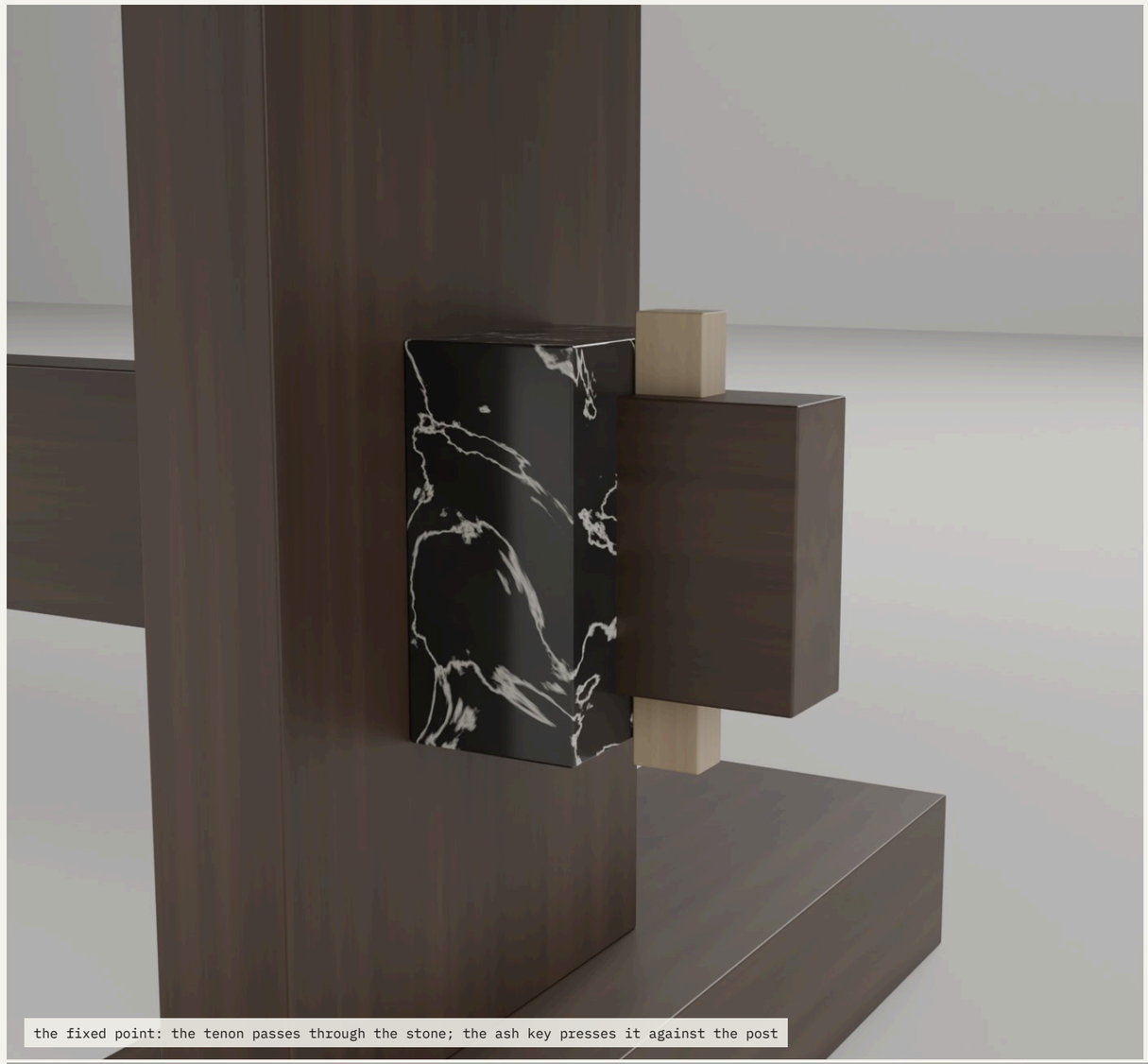
5 the central strut astride the stretcher



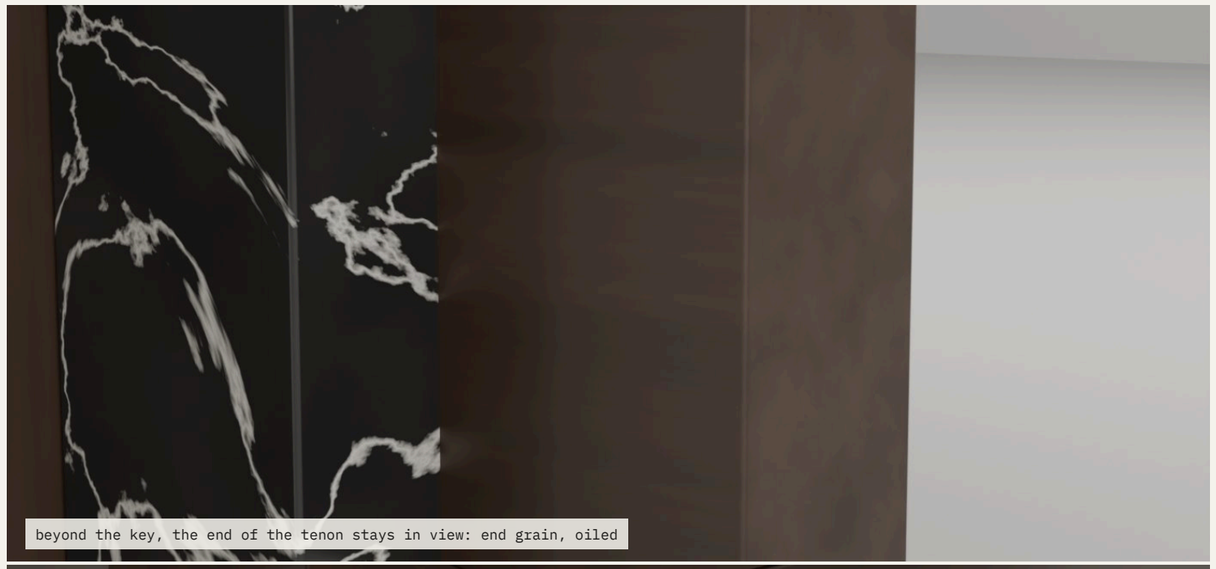
6 the boards with their dowels; splines between them



7 the wedges through the heads lock each board



the fixed point: the tenon passes through the stone; the ash key presses it against the post



beyond the key, the end of the tenon stays in view: end grain, oiled



twelve ash wedges through the heads: each board is locked on its own





from above: six boards, five joints